

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 58)

Page 287 - Virginia Woolf and E.M. Forster

Q1. For most readers, Virginia Woolf's easiest book is:

- A. The Waves
- B. The Years
- C. Orlando
- D. To the Lighthouse

Answer: C

Q2. 'Orlando' is described as a fantasy released from the bonds of:

- A. Love and hate
- B. Time and place
- C. Life and death
- D. Magic and reality

Answer: B

Q3. Which two novels have a firmer structure but are selected by many admirers as Virginia Woolf's masterpieces?

- A. Orlando and The Voyage Out
- B. The Waves and The Years
- C. To the Lighthouse and The Common Reader
- D. The Voyage Out and Orlando

Answer: B

Q4. Virginia Woolf's critical essays were collected in volumes such as:

- A. The Common Reader
- B. Abinger Harvest
- C. Two Cheers for Democracy
- D. Left Hand, Right Hand

Answer: A

Q5. E.M. Forster wrote literary criticism of exceptional quality in:

- A. The Common Reader

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- B. Abinger Harvest and Two Cheers for Democracy
- C. The Common Reader and Abinger Harvest
- D. Two Cheers for Democracy and The Common Reader

Answer: B

Q6. E.M. Forster carried into the twentieth century the ideals of which period?

- A. The Romantic period
- B. The Elizabethan age
- C. The Victorian liberal humanitarian ideals
- D. The Augustan satirical ideals

Answer: C

Q7. E.M. Forster can be called a 'novelist's novelist' whose influence on other writers has been pervasive, though in twenty years he produced only:

- A. Two novels
- B. Three novels
- C. Five novels
- D. Ten novels

Answer: C

Q8. Which novel by E.M. Forster was the most widely read until 'A Passage to India'?

- A. Howard's End
- B. The Celestial Omnibus
- C. The Hill of Devi
- D. A Room with a View

Answer: A

Q9. 'A Passage to India' is a troubling novel with a subtly studied character in the unjustly accused:

- A. Mr. Fielding
- B. Dr. Aziz
- C. Mrs. Moore
- D. Miss Quested

Answer: B

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Q10. The basis of personal experience for 'A Passage to India' can be found in a later book by Forster called:

- A. Abinger Harvest
- B. Two Cheers for Democracy
- C. The Hill of Devi
- D. The Celestial Omnibus

Answer: C

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Page 288 - James Joyce and Somerset Maugham

Q1. The works of James Joyce have attracted a small army of expositors and explainers, and his greatest novel is considered to be:

- A. Dubliners
- B. Ulysses
- C. Finnegans Wake
- D. Portrait of the Artist as a Young Man

Answer: B

Q2. 'Ulysses' is a long prose epic dealing with how many hours in the lives of a group of people in Dublin?

- A. 12 hours
- B. 24 hours
- C. 48 hours
- D. One week

Answer: B

Q3. Which of James Joyce's novels resembles a vast musical composition where sense gives way to sound?

- A. Ulysses
- B. Finnegans Wake
- C. Portrait of the Artist as a Young Man
- D. The Celestial Omnibus

Answer: B

Q4. 'Finnegans Wake' is described as a night in the dream world of a character named:

- A. Stephen Dedalus
- B. Leopold Bloom
- C. H.C. Earwaker
- D. Dr. Aziz

Answer: C

Q5. An earlier book by Joyce, which is relatively straightforward, is:

- A. Finnegans Wake

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- B. Ulysses
- C. Portrait of the Artist as a Young Man
- D. The Hill of Devi

Answer: C

Q6. Somerset Maugham began to write in the:

- A. 1880s
- B. 1890s
- C. 1910s
- D. 1920s

Answer: B

Q7. Somerset Maugham was for a long time underestimated by critics who were misled by his:

- A. Experimental style
- B. Immense wealth
- C. Popularity among ordinary readers
- D. Political views

Answer: C

Q8. Which of the following is considered one of Somerset Maugham's first-rate novels?

- A. Of Human Bondage
- B. Finnegans Wake
- C. Howard's End
- D. Ulysses

Answer: A

Q9. 'The Circle' and 'Our Betters' are notable plays by:

- A. Bernard Shaw
- B. James Bridie
- C. Somerset Maugham
- D. J.B. Priestley

Answer: C

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Q10. Who was the controversial figure who might have been accepted as a great novelist if not for his mission to release people from moral restraints?

- A. James Joyce
- B. D.H. Lawrence
- C. Aldous Huxley
- D. George Orwell

Answer: B

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Page 289 - Satirists and Younger Novelists

Q1. In the 1920s, Aldous Huxley appeared like a modern:

- A. Shakespeare
- B. Jonathan Swift
- C. Charles Dickens
- D. Alexander Pope

Answer: B

Q2. 'Point Counter Point' was a book by Aldous Huxley that contained:

- A. A romantic story of medieval knights
- B. Bitter satirical portraits of writers and intellectual society
- C. A utopian vision of the future
- D. A philosophical discourse on religion

Answer: B

Q3. In 1932, Aldous Huxley envisaged a future in which the populace would be mentally conditioned by totalitarian despots in his book:

- A. Animal Farm
- B. Nineteen Eighty-Four
- C. Brave New World
- D. Mortal Coils

Answer: C

Q4. Who developed the theme of a totalitarian future in still darker tones in 'Nineteen Eighty-Four'?

- A. Aldous Huxley
- B. George Orwell
- C. Graham Greene
- D. Evelyn Waugh

Answer: B

Q5. George Orwell suddenly became widely known in 1945 for his short political satire titled:

- A. Brave New World

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- B. Point Counter Point
- C. Animal Farm
- D. Antic Hay

Answer: C

Q6. 'Sinister Street', a fine novel of childhood and young manhood at Oxford, made which author famous?

- A. Hugh Walpole
- B. Compton Mackenzie
- C. J.B. Priestley
- D. Graham Greene

Answer: B

Q7. J.B. Priestley's 'The Good Companions' seemed to restore to general favour the full-blooded novel resembling the works of:

- A. Jonathan Swift
- B. Charles Dickens
- C. Virginia Woolf
- D. D.H. Lawrence

Answer: B

Q8. Which younger novelist took a leading place after the second World War by plunging his characters into depths of degradation?

- A. Graham Greene
- B. Evelyn Waugh
- C. Charles Morgan
- D. Joyce Cary

Answer: A

Q9. In Graham Greene's novels, characters are often redeemed only by the way of:

- A. Social revolution
- B. Divine compassion and salvation
- C. Financial success
- D. Scientific progress

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Answer: B

Q10. Like Graham Greene, Evelyn Waugh has religious implications in his novels because he is a:

- A. Devout Anglican
- B. Roman Catholic
- C. Methodist minister
- D. Quaker

Answer: B

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Page 290 - Later Novelists and Women Writers

Q1. Evelyn Waugh began as a farcical humorist in stories such as:

- A. Brighton Rock and The Heart of the Matter
- B. Decline and Fall and Vile Bodies
- C. Animal Farm and Nineteen Eighty-Four
- D. Of Human Bondage and Cakes and Ale

Answer: B

Q2. Which of the following is considered Evelyn Waugh's best sober novel?

- A. The Loved One
- B. Decline and Fall
- C. Vile Bodies
- D. Brideshead Revisited

Answer: D

Q3. Charles Morgan's novels, such as 'The Fountain' and 'The Judge's Story', are marked rather by a:

- A. Roughly hewn realism
- B. Carefully groomed style
- C. Bitter satirical tone
- D. Farce and humor

Answer: B

Q4. Which novelist was outstanding among recent novelists for his varied selection and treatment of subjects, passing from African life to wartime evacuee children?

- A. Charles Morgan
- B. Joyce Cary
- C. Evelyn Waugh
- D. Graham Greene

Answer: B

Q5. Joyce Cary wrote a novel about the shameless doings of a rascally artist named Jimson titled:

- A. The African Witch

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- B. Charley is My Darling
- C. The House of Children
- D. The Horse's Mouth

Answer: D

Q6. The rapid growth of what led increasing numbers of women to take up a literary career?

- A. University education for women
- B. Voting rights
- C. Urban populations
- D. Industrial factories

Answer: A

Q7. Rose Macaulay wrote an excellent historical novel of the seventeenth century titled:

- A. Told by an Idiot
- B. They Were Defeated
- C. The World My Wilderness
- D. Parents and Children

Answer: B

Q8. Ivy Compton-Burnett is described as a more difficult but more original and penetrating writer, known for novels such as:

- A. The World My Wilderness
- B. Parents and Children
- C. Death of the Heart
- D. The Man Born to be King

Answer: B

Q9. Whose novels and short stories are said to have the literary distinction of Virginia Woolf but with a firmer outline and satisfying grasp of character?

- A. Rose Macaulay
- B. Ivy Compton-Burnett
- C. Elizabeth Bowen
- D. Dorothy Sayers

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Answer: C

Q10. Dorothy Sayers gave the detective novel an intellectual and religious significance before turning to broadcast Christian plays like:

- A. Death of the Heart
- B. They Were Defeated
- C. The Man Born to be King
- D. Parents and Children

Answer: C

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Page 291 - The Short Story and Prose Drama

Q1. The English short story ventured into different paths in the 1920s, largely under the influence of the Russian writer:

- A. Tolstoy
- B. Dostoevsky
- C. Tchekov (Chekhov)
- D. Pushkin

Answer: C

Q2. The influence of Tchekov concentrated on:

- A. Complex plots and fast action
- B. Atmosphere rather than plot and firm characterisation
- C. Political propaganda
- D. Historical facts

Answer: B

Q3. Katherine Mansfield was born in:

- A. England
- B. France
- C. New Zealand
- D. Germany

Answer: C

Q4. Katherine Mansfield's carefully composed style was allied with a remarkable power of understanding:

- A. Political leaders
- B. Children, and also unhappy and thwarted people
- C. Criminals and detectives
- D. Military commanders

Answer: B

Q5. Bernard Shaw continued to write almost up to the time of his death in 1950 at the age of:

- A. Eighty

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- B. Eighty-five
- C. Ninety
- D. Ninety-four

Answer: D

Q6. It is the general opinion that Bernard Shaw wrote nothing important after:

- A. The Apple Cart
- B. Saint Joan
- C. Village Wooing
- D. Pygmalion

Answer: B

Q7. The text asserts it is obtuse to deny high merit to which two later plays by Bernard Shaw?

- A. The Apple Cart and Village Wooing
- B. Saint Joan and The Apple Cart
- C. Major Barbara and Village Wooing
- D. The Doctor's Dilemma and The Apple Cart

Answer: A

Q8. Bernard Shaw's great virtue as a writer on current topics was that he:

- A. Always agreed with popular prejudices
- B. Saw beyond immediate problems and refused to be swayed by popular prejudices
- C. Focused strictly on aesthetics
- D. Ignored politics entirely

Answer: B

Q9. Who was the only other prose dramatist in the second quarter of this century whose plays are as good to read in print as to see in a theatre?

- A. James Bridie
- B. Christopher Fry
- C. T.S. Eliot
- D. Somerset Maugham

Answer: A

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Q10. Before turning to authorship, James Bridie practised as a:

- A. Lawyer
- B. Doctor
- C. Teacher
- D. Priest

Answer: B